

Weekly Quizzes

JS-310 | The Eastern European Jewish Experience through Literature and Film

Instructor: Andrzej Brylak / Yulia Dubasova

Term: Fall 2026

Assignment Summary

Grade weight: 30%

Group project: No

Overview (Grading breakdown)

Weekly Quizzes 30

Assignment Description

Each Tuesday, at the beginning of each instructional week, students will be given a quiz on the content of the reading/viewing. 10 closed-ended questions, quiz to be taken on a phone or laptop.

Weekly Readings (quiz content)

- Week 1: Eastern European Jewish Experience: Historical Introduction | (Text on Brightspace); Antony Polonsky, *Jews in Poland and Russia: A Short History* (Excerpt).
- Week 2: Small Town Jewish Life | Sholem Aleichem, *Tevye the Dairyman and Motl the Cantor's Son*, pp. 1-135
- Week 3: Tradition vs Modernity | Sholem Aleichem, *Tevye the Dairyman and Motl the Cantor's Son*, pp. 135-235
- Week 4: Jewish Emigration | Sholem Aleichem, *Tevye the Dairyman and Motl the Cantor's Son*, pp. 235-281
- Week 5: Americanization | Sholem Aleichem, *Tevye the Dairyman and Motl the Cantor's Son*, pp. 281-375
- Week 6: Jewish Criminal Underground | Isaac Babel, *Odessa Stories*, pp. 1-103
- Week 7: Jewish Childhood | Isaac Babel, *Odessa Stories*, pp. 103-175
- Week 8: Holocaust and the Problem of Its Representation | Film: *Unzere Kinder*, dir. Natan Gross.
- Week 9: Holocaust Literature: Characteristics | Imre Kertesz, *Fatelessness*, pp. 1-99
- Week 10: Irony in Holocaust Literature | Imre Kertesz, *Fatelessness*, pp. 99-189
- Week 11: Testimony as a Genre. Ethics and Poetics. | Imre Kertesz, *Fatelessness*, pp. 189- 262; Film: *Everything is Illuminated*, dir. Liev Schreiber
- Week 12: Jewish American Literature | Gary Shteyngart, *Super Sad True Love Story*, pp. 1- 98
- Week 13: Eastern European Influence on Contemporary Jewish Identity in America | Gary Shteyngart, *Super Sad True Love Story*, pp. 98-203

- Week 14: Jewishness and Postmodernism | Gary Shteyngart, *Super Sad True Love Story*, pp. 203-330
- Week 14: Jews and Money | Film: *Uncut Gems*, dir. Safdie Brothers

Full Syllabus Extract

Each Tuesday, at the beginning of each instructional week, students will be given a quiz on the content of the reading/viewing. 10 closed-ended questions, quiz to be taken on a phone or laptop.

*Week 1: Eastern European Jewish Experience: Historical Introduction | (Text on Brightspace); Antony Polonsky, *Jews in Poland and Russia: A Short History* (Excerpt).*

*Week 11: Testimony as a Genre. Ethics and Poetics. | Imre Kertesz, *Fatelessness*, pp. 189- 262; Film: *Everything is Illuminated*, dir. Liev Schreiber*

*Week 13: Eastern European Influence on Contemporary Jewish Identity in America | Gary Shteyngart, *Super Sad True Love Story*, pp. 98-203*

*Week 3: Tradition vs Modernity | Sholem Aleichem, *Tevye the Dairyman and Motl the Cantor's Son*, pp. 135-235*

*Week 2: Small Town Jewish Life | Sholem Aleichem, *Tevye the Dairyman and Motl the Cantor's Son*, pp. 1-135*

*Week 4: Jewish Emigration | Sholem Aleichem, *Tevye the Dairyman and Motl the Cantor's Son*, pp. 235-281*

*Week 5: Americanization | Sholem Aleichem, *Tevye the Dairyman and Motl the Cantor's Son*, pp. 281-375*

*Week 8: Holocaust and the Problem of Its Representation | Film: *Unzere Kinder*, dir. Natan Gross.*

*Week 14: Jewishness and Postmodernism | Gary Shteyngart, *Super Sad True Love Story*, pp. 203- 330*

*Week 12: Jewish American Literature | Gary Shteyngart, *Super Sad True Love Story*, pp. 1- 98*

*Week 9: Holocaust Literature: Characteristics | Imre Kertesz, *Fatelessness*, pp. 1-99*

Week 10: Irony in Holocaust Literature | Imre Kertesz, Fatelessness, pp. 99-189

Week 6: Jewish Criminal Underground | Issac Babel, Odessa Stories, pp. 1-103

Week 7: Jewish Childhood | Isaac Babel, Odessa Stories, pp. 103-175

Week 14: Jews and Money | Film: Uncut Gems, dir. Safdie Brothers

Weekly Quizzes 30